Dunford’s 5-Component Positioning Framework

If our solution ceased to exist tomorrow, what specific alternatives would customers use, and what distinct value do our unique capabilities deliver over those alternatives?



SCHEMATIC

Ledger at part 1 of 5

BRA-01

Dunford's 5-Component Positioning Framework

ARTIFACT

A 5-column positioning ledger: Competitive Alternatives → Unique Capabilities → Quantified Value Drivers → Ideal Customer Profile (ICP) Segments → Category Framing.

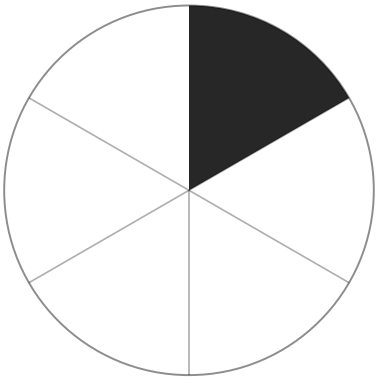
ANTI-PATTERN

Declaring that no direct competitors exist, or positioning into ill-defined space, deprives buyers of an evaluative frame.

April Dunford (2019)

Kapferer’s Brand Identity Prism

How do our external physical codes and relational behaviors mirror the internal culture of our organization and the aspirational self-image of our buyer?



SCHEMATIC

Facets at facet 1 of 6

BRA-02

Kapferer’s Brand Identity Prism

ARTIFACT

A six-facet identity prism: Physique, Personality, Culture, Relationship, Reflection, Self-Image.

ANTI-PATTERN

An identity built entirely on Reflection: customer-pandering marketing with no operational or cultural grounding.

Jean-Noël Kapferer (1992)

Keller’s Customer-Based Brand Equity (CBBE) Pyramid

Have we established sufficient brand salience and performance credibility to support an emotional brand response and active consumer resonance?



SCHEMATIC

Tiers at level 1 of 4

BRA-03

Keller’s Customer-Based Brand Equity (CBBE) Pyramid

ARTIFACT

A four-tier equity ladder: Salience, Performance & Imagery, Judgments & Feelings, Resonance.

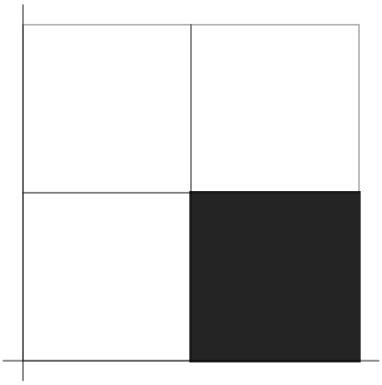
ANTI-PATTERN

Buying resonance campaigns before functional performance and category salience are established: hollow recognition, no conversion.

Kevin Lane Keller (1993, 2001)

Blue Ocean Strategy Canvas & ERRC Grid

Which category conventions can we discard, which must we reduce below standard, and which neglected factors should we elevate to break industry trade-offs?



SCHEMATIC

Matrix at cell 4 of 4

BRA-04

Blue Ocean Strategy Canvas & ERRC Grid

ARTIFACT

A Strategic Value Curve Chart paired with an Eliminate-Reduce-Raise-Create (ERRC) Operational Matrix mapping asymmetric investment against industry benchmarks.

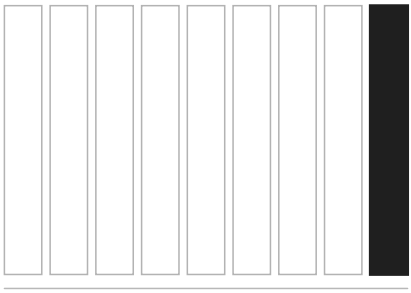
ANTI-PATTERN

Benchmark convergence: competing on every established axis drives up marginal cost and ends in commoditization.

W. Chan Kim & Renée Mauborgne (2005)

Unilever Brand Key

What foundational root strengths and underlying human insights give the brand the commercial authority to claim its core discriminator?



SCHEMATIC

Ledger at part 9 of 9

BRA-05

Unilever Brand Key

ARTIFACT

The 9-Element Brand Key Blueprint: Root Strength → Competitive Environment → Target Audience → Human Insight → Benefits (Functional & Emotional) → Values & Personality → Reasons to Believe (RTB) → Discriminator → Brand Essence.

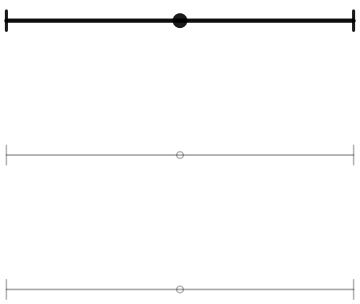
ANTI-PATTERN

Writing the Human Insight as an obvious functional observation instead of the underlying psychological tension.

Unilever Global Marketing Practice (c. 1995)

Treacy & Wiersema’s Value Disciplines

Are we positioned primarily around Operational Excellence (cost, reliability, efficiency), Product Leadership (continuous innovation, status), or Customer Intimacy (tailored flexibility, relationship depth)?



SCHEMATIC

Axes at axis 1 of 3

BRA-06

Treacy & Wiersema's Value Disciplines

ARTIFACT

A Value Trilemma Optimization Map establishing a primary operational focus alongside non-negotiable performance thresholds for the other two disciplines.

ANTI-PATTERN

Promising market-leading craftsmanship, lowest category pricing, and bespoke personalization simultaneously, which confuses operational priorities.

Michael Treacy & Fred Wiersema (1993)

Trout & Ries Positioning & Category Law

What single word, category rung, or pre-existing cognitive bias does our brand own to the exclusion of all competitors?



SCHEMATIC

Ledger at part 1 of 3

BRA-07

Trout & Ries Positioning & Category Law

ARTIFACT

A Category Ladder Ledger detailing: the Top-of-Mind Category Leader, the Antithetical Second-Rung Position (the "un-leader"), and a Singular Word Association Register.

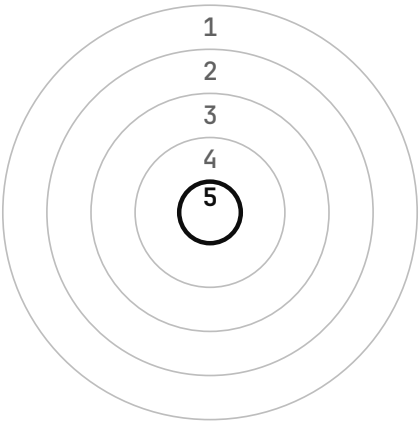
ANTI-PATTERN

Diluting a focused mental position by stretching the brand name across unrelated market segments and products.

Al Ries & Jack Trout (1981)

The Brand Essence Wheel

When outer technical facts and user benefits are distilled inward, what two-to-three word essence captures the central promise of the brand?



SCHEMATIC

Rings at ring 5 of 5

BRA-08

The Brand Essence Wheel

ARTIFACT

A 5-Ring Concentric Essence Wheel moving inward from Physical Attributes & Facts to Functional Benefits, Emotional Payoffs, Personality Archetypes, and the central Brand Essence.

ANTI-PATTERN

Choosing an interchangeable abstraction for the essence — Trust, Innovation, Quality — which carries zero competitive tension.

Bates Worldwide / Richard Macrae & Robin Wensley (1990s)

The Brand Onion Model

How do our daily visual and verbal touchpoints connect directly back to our non-negotiable core values and foundational convictions?



SCHEMATIC

Tiers at level 1 of 4

BRA-09

The Brand Onion Model

ARTIFACT

A Multi-Tiered Behavioral Onion Map: Core Values → Brand Essence → Character & Positioning → External Expressions and Manifestations.

ANTI-PATTERN

Treating the outer behavioral layer as a styling exercise while leaving the core values too broad to guide real business trade-offs.

Consumer Goods Strategy Practice (1990s)

Geoffrey Moore’s Crossing the Chasm Positioning Template

Can our leadership team state our fundamental commercial position in a single sentence using a fixed, adjective-free syntax?



SCHEMATIC

Statement at clause 1 of 6

BRA-10

Geoffrey Moore’s Crossing the Chasm Positioning Template

ARTIFACT

For [target customer segment]
Who [statement of specific need or pain]
The [product name] is a [product category]
That [statement of compelling key benefit]
Unlike [primary competitive alternative]
Our product [statement of primary differentiation].

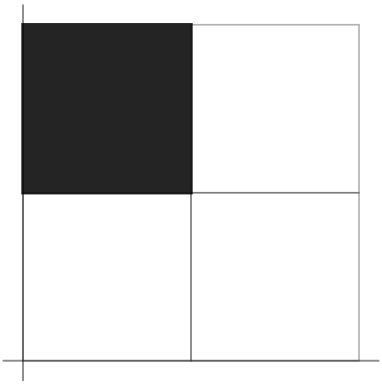
ANTI-PATTERN

Overloading the clauses with buzzwords, which breaks the framework's forcing function.

Geoffrey A. Moore (1991)

Christensen’s Jobs-to-be-Done (JTBD) Brand Placement

What functional, emotional, and social 'job' is the customer hiring our brand to resolve, and what incumbent habits or solutions must be 'fired'?



SCHEMATIC

Matrix at cell 1 of 4

BRA-11

Christensen’s Jobs-to-be-Done (JTBD) Brand Placement

ARTIFACT

A JTBD Forces of Progress Blueprint mapping the push of the current situation, the pull of the new solution, the anxiety of change, and the inertia of existing habits.

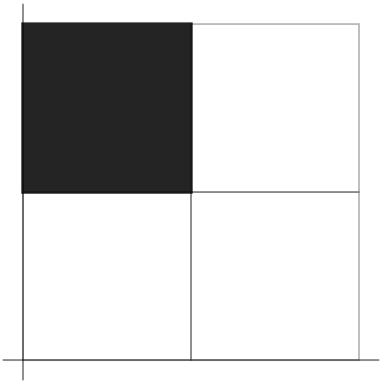
ANTI-PATTERN

Defining the brand's addressable market solely through demographic profiles rather than the situational triggers that drive buying decisions.

Clayton M. Christensen, Scott Cook & Taddy Hall (2016)

Pearson-Jung 12 Brand Archetypes

Which universal subconscious archetype governs our brand's behavioral defaults, motivation, and cultural stance?



SCHEMATIC

Matrix at cell 1 of 4

BRA-12

Pearson-Jung 12 Brand Archetypes

ARTIFACT

Two axes (Stability vs. Disruption; Belonging vs. Autonomy) yield a primary and a secondary archetype, with core drivers, fears and taboos.

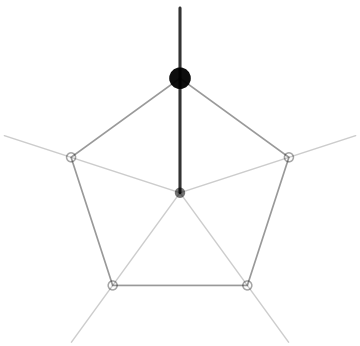
ANTI-PATTERN

Picking an archetype as decoration while operations contradict its ethos — an *Outlaw* run under strict risk aversion.

Carol S. Pearson & Margaret Mark (2001)

Aaker’s Brand Personality Dimensions

How does the brand score across the five validated psychological dimensions, and which sub-facets serve as non-negotiable behavioral boundaries?



SCHEMATIC

Score at dimension 1 of 5

BRA-13

Aaker’s Brand Personality Dimensions

ARTIFACT

A 42-Facet Personality Trait Scorecard evaluating the brand on a 1–5 scale across five primary dimensions: Sincerity, Excitement, Competence, Sophistication, and Ruggedness.

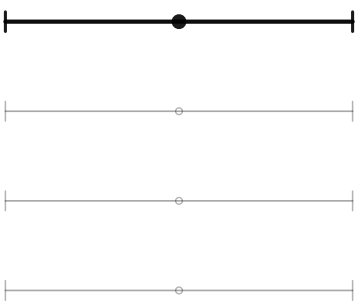
ANTI-PATTERN

Scoring high across all five dimensions simultaneously, resulting in a diffuse identity profile that dilutes recognition.

Jennifer L. Aaker (1997)

Nielsen Norman Group (NN/g) 4 Dimensions of Tone of Voice

Where does our content fall along the four universal tonal axes across different user states and contexts?



SCHEMATIC

Axes at axis 1 of 4

BRA-14

Nielsen Norman Group (NN/g) 4 Dimensions of Tone of Voice

ARTIFACT

Four bipolar axes — Funny↔Serious, Formal↔Casual, Respectful↔Irreverent, Matter-of-Fact↔Enthusiastic — each with copy treatments across onboarding, core tasks and system errors.

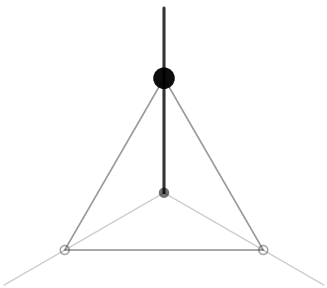
ANTI-PATTERN

Staying playful through critical failures — a failed transaction, a locked account — alienates users already under stress.

Nielsen Norman Group (Kate Moran, 2016)

Brand Personality Appeal (BPA) Model

Is our brand personality distinct enough to be recognized, favorable enough to drive preference, and clear enough to prevent internal misinterpretation?



SCHEMATIC

Score at dimension 1 of 3

BRA-15

Brand Personality Appeal (BPA) Model

ARTIFACT

A three-factor audit: Personality Favorability, Personality Originality, Personality Clarity.

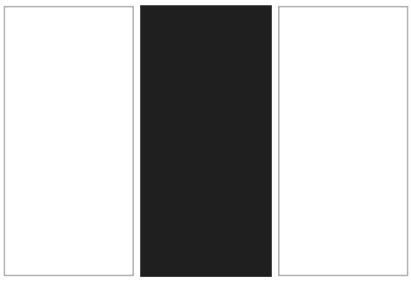
ANTI-PATTERN

Chasing originality that fails favorability: eccentricities added for novelty raise friction at adoption.

Traci H. Freling, Jody L. Crosno & David H. Henard (2011)

Jungian Shadow Archetypes in Enterprise Culture

What toxic behavioral shadow does our primary archetype risk becoming when our organization is placed under commercial pressure, and what structural safeguards prevent its manifestation?



SCHEMATIC

Ledger at part 2 of 3

BRA-16

Jungian Shadow Archetypes in Enterprise Culture

ARTIFACT

A shadow register: the primary archetype, the state it becomes under pressure (*Hero* → *Arrogant Bully*; *Sage* → *Pedantic Academic*; *Ruler* → *Authoritarian Tyrant*), and the policies that prevent it.

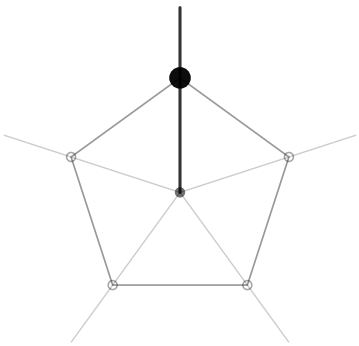
ANTI-PATTERN

Ignoring shadow states during high-growth cycles, allowing latent behaviors to turn public marketing campaigns into brand crises.

Carl G. Jung, applied by Pearson & Mark (2001)

Five-Factor (OCEAN) Brand Mapping

If evaluated through standardized psychometric testing, what exact trait distribution governs our corporate communications?



SCHEMATIC

Score at dimension 1 of 5

BRA-17

Five-Factor (OCEAN) Brand Mapping

ARTIFACT

A radar chart scoring the five factors: Openness, Conscientiousness, Extraversion, Agreeableness, Neuroticism.

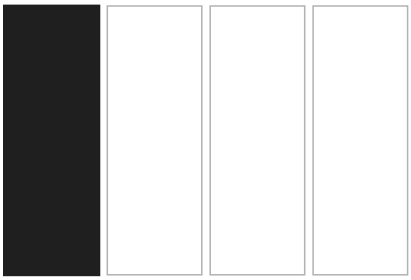
ANTI-PATTERN

Mirroring the founder's uncalibrated traits instead of engineering the profile the target market requires.

Gian Vittorio Caprara, Claudio Barbaranelli & Gianluigi Guido (2001)

The Brand Voice Compass & Sliders

What specific lexical, structural, and grammatical rules define each of our brand personality traits in practical writing?



SCHEMATIC

Ledger at part 1 of 4

BRA-18

The Brand Voice Compass & Sliders

ARTIFACT

Trait Name
Positive Definition: what the trait actively is
Negative Boundary: what it must never become
Side-by-side "Use This / Avoid That" copy examples

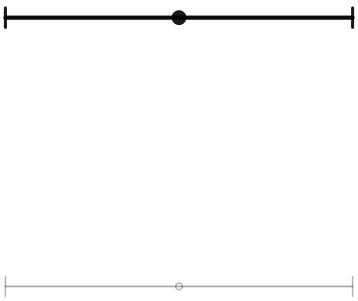
ANTI-PATTERN

Listing broad adjectives — Bold, Smart, Human — with no boundaries, leaving copywriters nothing to act on.

The source names no originator.

Dialectical Tonal Polarity Matrix

What opposing behavioral tensions must our brand balance to avoid collapsing into a flat, predictable stereotype?



SCHEMATIC

Axes at axis 1 of 2

BRA-19

Dialectical Tonal Polarity Matrix

ARTIFACT

Trait tensions: *Deeply Technical* yet *Instantly Plainspoken*; *Pragmatic and Grounded* yet *Uncompromisingly Visionary*.
Calibration bounds marking the point where each extreme turns destructive.

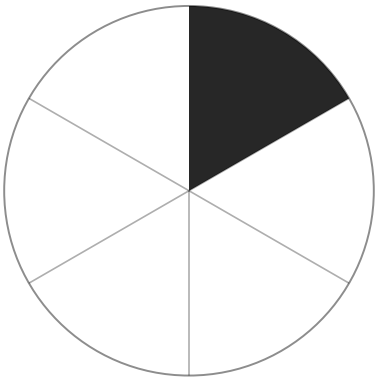
ANTI-PATTERN

Resolving the tension by softening both sides toward a bland middle ground, erasing distinctiveness.

The source names no originator.

Fournier's Brand Relationship Quality (BRQ) Model

What specific relational contract does our brand form with the customer, and do our operational touchpoints reinforce or break that contract?



SCHEMATIC

Facets at facet 1 of 6

BRA-20

Fournier’s Brand Relationship Quality (BRQ) Model

ARTIFACT

Six facets — Love/Passion, Self-Connection, Interdependence, Commitment, Intimacy, Brand Partner Quality — scored across relationship archetypes such as Committed Partnership or Secret Fling.

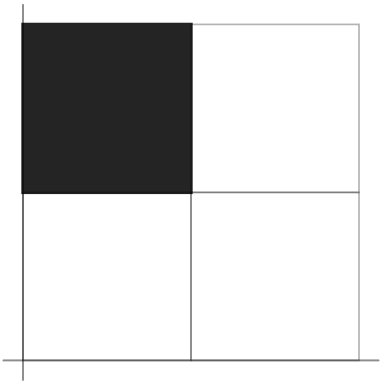
ANTI-PATTERN

Using an intimate, conversational tone when the business reality is an opportunistic transaction reads as false.

Susan Fournier (1998)

Greimasian Brand Semiotic Square

What structural oppositions and contradictions define the narrative space of our category, and what unexplored territory can we claim?



SCHEMATIC

Matrix at cell 1 of 4

BRA-21

Greimasian Brand Semiotic Square

ARTIFACT

A 4-Corner Structural Semiotic Matrix: Primary Assertion (S1) vs. Contrary (S2), and Contradictory (~ S1) vs. Sub-Contrary (~ S2), mapping category positions and white space.

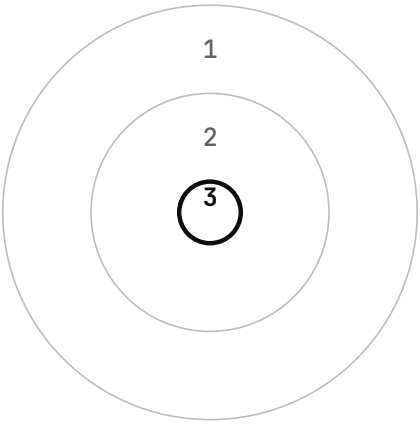
ANTI-PATTERN

Positioning a brand on an unresolved contradictory axis without addressing the underlying semantic trade-offs.

Algirdas Julien Greimas (1966), adapted by Jean-Marie Floch (1988)

Simon Sinek’s Golden Circle

Why does our enterprise exist beyond generating profit, and does that purpose consistently drive our operating principles and product output?



SCHEMATIC

Rings at ring 3 of 3

BRA-22

Simon Sinek's Golden Circle

ARTIFACT

A Concentric Why-How-What Blueprint: Why (the foundational cause or conviction), How (the proprietary operating principles), and What (the tangible products and services).

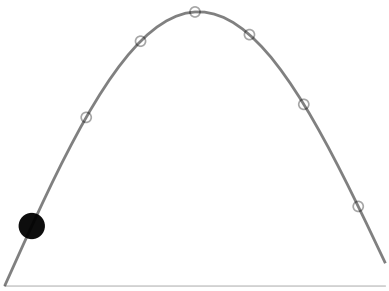
ANTI-PATTERN

Inventing an ungrounded social crusade for a functional utility business, resulting in transparent purpose-washing.

Simon Sinek (2009)

The Brand Story Canvas

How does our brand narrative guide the customer through their struggle against an obstacle toward an altered state of success?



SCHEMATIC

Arc at stage 1 of 7

BRA-23

The Brand Story Canvas

ARTIFACT

A Single-Page Strategic Storyboard: Protagonist → Inciting Incident → External/Internal Conflict → The Guide → The Action Plan → The Climax → The New Status Quo.

ANTI-PATTERN

Making the company the hero of the story rather than positioning the customer as the protagonist and the brand as the guide.

The source names no originator.

Purpose-Mission-Vision-Values (PMVV) Alignment Hierarchy

Are our Purpose, Mission, Vision, and Values structurally delineated, or do they collapse into a single corporate statement?



SCHEMATIC

Tiers at level 1 of 4

BRA-24

Purpose-Mission-Vision-Values (PMVV) Alignment Hierarchy

ARTIFACT

Purpose: the enduring reason for being (permanent).
Mission: the high-priority operational objective over a 3–5 year horizon (dynamic).
Vision: the future market state realized once the mission succeeds (long-term).
Values: the boundaries that will not be compromised, even at a financial loss (ethical).

ANTI-PATTERN

Adopting generic corporate hygiene factors — Integrity, Excellence, Teamwork — as values without defining the trade-offs they require.

Peter Drucker; Jim Collins & Jerry Porras (1994)

The Enemy/Rival Category Narrative

What systemic injustice, flawed industry consensus, or operational failure serves as our brand's philosophical antagonist?



SCHEMATIC

Ledger at part 1 of 3

BRA-25

The Enemy/Rival Category Narrative

ARTIFACT

An Antagonist Dossier & Contrarian Manifesto: the systemic adversary (e.g., *The Fragmentation of Data*, *Vendor Lock-in*), the impact on the customer, and the brand's path to overcoming it.

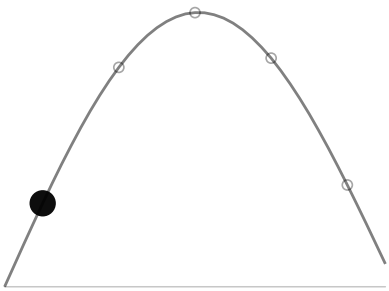
ANTI-PATTERN

Targeting a specific corporate competitor by name, which can appear petty and reduces the brand's category leadership.

Play Bigger (2016); Alex M. H. Smith (2020)

Andy Raskin’s 5-Element Strategic Narrative

Does our narrative open with an undeniable shift in the macro environment that creates urgency, or are we leading with self-centered product pitches?



SCHEMATIC

Arc at stage 1 of 5

BRA-26

Andy Raskin’s 5-Element Strategic Narrative

ARTIFACT

Name an undeniable shift in the world.
Demonstrate there will be winners and losers (the stakes).
Tease the promised land — the future state, independent of features.
Introduce product capabilities as "magic gifts" to reach that state.
Present concrete evidence that the vision can be realized.

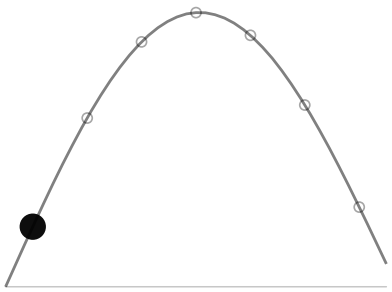
ANTI-PATTERN

Opening with a slide that tells the prospect their current approach is broken, which triggers immediate resistance.

Andy Raskin (2016)

Donald Miller’s StoryBrand Framework (SB7)

Can an uninformed user understand what we offer, what problem it resolves, and how to buy it within five seconds of landing on our touchpoint?



SCHEMATIC

Arc at stage 1 of 7

BRA-27

Donald Miller's StoryBrand Framework (SB7)

ARTIFACT

A 7-Part Grunt-Tested BrandScript: Character → Problem (External, Internal, Philosophical) → Guide (Empathy + Authority) → Plan → Call to Action → Avoided Failure → Resulting Success.

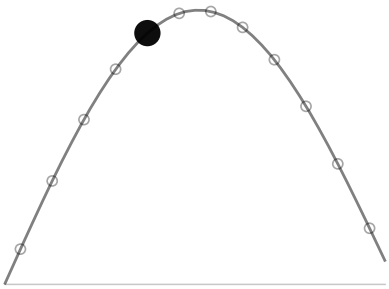
ANTI-PATTERN

Cluttering above-the-fold messaging with internal corporate milestones, history, or technical jargon rather than clarifying user progress.

Donald Miller (2017)

Campbellian Monomyth Brand Adaptation

What threshold of change is our customer hesitant to cross, and how does our brand serve as the mentor providing the tools to succeed?



SCHEMATIC

Arc at stage 5 of 12

BRA-28

Campbellian Monomyth Brand Adaptation

ARTIFACT

A 12-stage journey map: Ordinary World, Call to Adventure, Refusal of the Call, Meeting the Mentor, Crossing the Threshold, Tests/Allies/Enemies, Inmost Cave, Supreme Ordeal, Reward, The Road Back, Resurrection, Return with the Elixir.

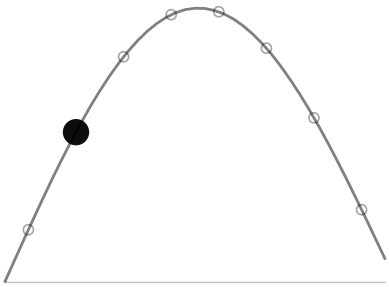
ANTI-PATTERN

Melodramatizing low-involvement or routine purchases, alienating practical buyers.

Joseph Campbell (1949); Christopher Vogler (1992)

McKee’s Storynomics Narrative Engine

What unexpected event breaks our customer's status quo, and what progressive gaps between expectation and reality must they navigate?



SCHEMATIC

Arc at stage 2 of 8

BRA-29

McKee’s Storynomics Narrative Engine

ARTIFACT

An Expectation-Gap Narrative Graph: Baseline Equilibrium → Inciting Incident → Object of Desire → Action → Gap (Expectation vs. Reality) → Escalating Conflict → Decisive Crisis → Re-established Equilibrium.

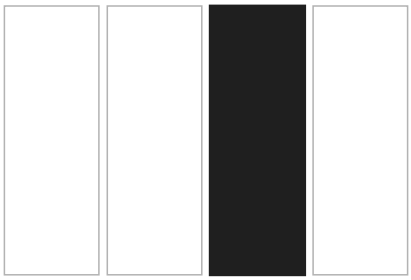
ANTI-PATTERN

Presenting an idealized, friction-free customer journey that fails to acknowledge real implementation obstacles.

Robert McKee & Thomas Gerace (2018)

Alex M. H. Smith’s Contrarian Worldview Framing

What widely accepted industry best practice does our brand reject, and what distinct business model do we employ instead?



SCHEMATIC

Ledger at part 3 of 4

BRA-30

Alex M. H. Smith's Contrarian Worldview Framing

ARTIFACT

A Contrarian Doctrine Specification: The Industry Consensus ⟶ Why the Consensus Fails ⟶ Our Contrarian Stance ⟶ The Asymmetric Advantage Unlocked.

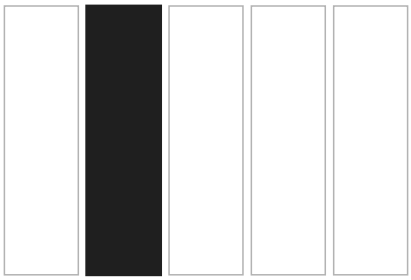
ANTI-PATTERN

Choosing a pseudo-contrarian platitude everyone already accepts — customers first — which removes the strategic edge.

Alex M. H. Smith (2020)

Luxury & Industrial Origin Myth Archetype

What authentic founding struggle, breakthrough, or distinct physical setting provides our brand with durable legitimacy?



SCHEMATIC

Ledger at part 2 of 5

BRA-31

Luxury & Industrial Origin Myth Archetype

ARTIFACT

A Heritage Genesis Dossier capturing: The Moment of Inception, The Trial of the Founder, The Physical Workshop/Place of Origin, The Breakthrough Artifact, and The Ongoing Craft Ritual.

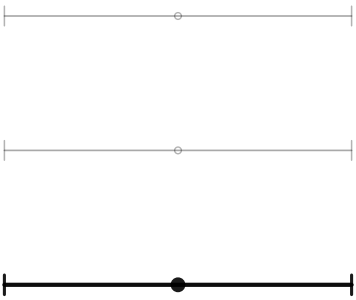
ANTI-PATTERN

Fabricating romantic heritage narratives for modern, venture-funded digital utilities.

Jean-Noël Kapferer & Vincent Bastien (2009)

Customer Identity Transformation Arc

Beyond immediate functional deliverables, who does the customer become after adopting our brand into their workflow and identity?



SCHEMATIC

Axes at axis 3 of 3

BRA-32

Customer Identity Transformation Arc

ARTIFACT

A From-Through-To State Matrix: Initial Frustrated State → Enabling Brand Engine → Transformed Aspirational Identity.

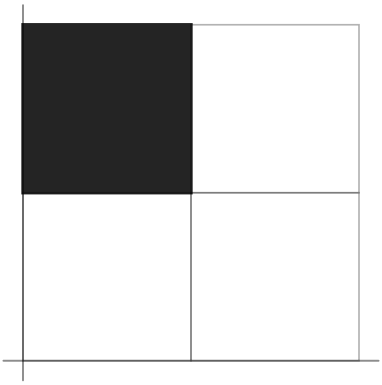
ANTI-PATTERN

Promising unrealistic life transformations for minor functional enhancements, which strains credibility.

B. Joseph Pine II & James H. Gilmore (1999)

Romaniuk's Distinctive Brand Asset (DBA) Grid

What proportion of market buyers correctly associate our non-logo assets with our brand, and what proportion mistakenly attribute them to a competitor?



SCHEMATIC

Matrix at cell 1 of 4

BRA-33

Romaniuk's Distinctive Brand Asset (DBA) Grid

ARTIFACT

Two axes: Fame (share of buyers linking the asset to the brand) and Uniqueness (share associating it only with the brand).
Automatic (high fame / high uniqueness): strong enough to replace the logo.
Investment Potential (low fame / high uniqueness): needs broad media reinforcement.
Avoid Solo Use (high fame / low uniqueness): prompts competitor recall alone.
Ignore or Test (low fame / low uniqueness): drains marketing resources.

ANTI-PATTERN

Redesigning established assets because the internal team is bored, which destroys earned market memory.

Jenni Romaniuk & Byron Sharp (2018)

Mental & Physical Availability Engine

Is our brand both mentally available (easily recalled in a buying situation) and physically available (accessible to purchase with minimal friction)?



SCHEMATIC

Score at dimension 1 of 2

BRA-34

Mental & Physical Availability Engine

ARTIFACT

A Dual-Availability Performance Index tracking mental metrics (salience, cue ownership) and physical metrics (channel distribution, shelf prominence, checkout friction).

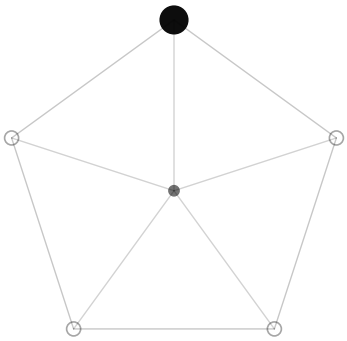
ANTI-PATTERN

Focusing exclusively on deep emotional loyalty among existing users while neglecting broad category mental reach and physical distribution.

Byron Sharp (2010)

Category Entry Points (CEPs) Mapping

Across all the discrete situations, emotional states, and environments that trigger category purchases, how many mental pathways connect to our brand?



SCHEMATIC

Network at node 1 of 5

BRA-35

Category Entry Points (CEPs) Mapping

ARTIFACT

A Cognitive Retrieval Network Map of the contextual triggers — Why, When, Where, With Whom, and With What buyers enter the market — paired with competitive ownership scores for each node.

ANTI-PATTERN

Concentrating brand messaging on a single niche entry point, which artificially caps market penetration.

Jenni Romaniuk & Byron Sharp (2016)

Helmer’s 7 Powers Brand Moat Matrix

Does our brand command a durable economic moat through Affective Valence (emotional affinity lowering price sensitivity) or Cognitive Shorthand (dramatically reducing customer search costs)?



SCHEMATIC

Score at dimension 1 of 2

BRA-36

Helmer’s 7 Powers Brand Moat Matrix

ARTIFACT

An Affective Valence & Pricing Delta Audit evaluating brand pricing power against generic functional alternatives, distinct from network effects, switching costs, or counter-positioning.

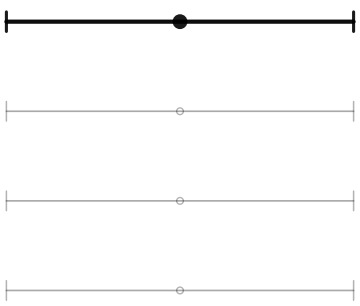
ANTI-PATTERN

Mistaking short-term brand engagement or viral attention for an enduring economic pricing power moat.

Hamilton Helmer (2016)

Brand Relationship Spectrum

Where does each product in our portfolio sit on the spectrum between a monolithic Branded House and an independent House of Brands?



SCHEMATIC

Axes at axis 1 of 4

BRA-37

Brand Relationship Spectrum

ARTIFACT

A 4-Model Architectural Continuum Ledger defining Master Brands, Sub-Brands, Endorsed Brands, and House of Brands assets, detailing how equity transfers between products.

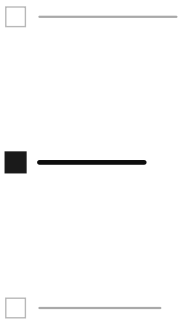
ANTI-PATTERN

Creating an uncoordinated House of Brands architecture at startup scale, fragmenting engineering focus and marketing budgets.

David A. Aaker & Erich Joachimsthaler (2000)

W3C DTCG Tokenized Design Engine

Are our core visual brand assets stored in static mockups, or are they declared as platform-agnostic, version-controlled JSON tokens?



SCHEMATIC

Manifest at key 2 of 3

BRA-38

W3C DTCG Tokenized Design Engine

ARTIFACT

A validated, multi-tier `tokens.json` schema separating primitive values from semantic aliases using standardized `$value`, `$type`, and `$description` properties.

ANTI-PATTERN

Treating design tokens merely as a color variable list rather than an integrated typographic, spatial, and semantic decision engine.

W3C Design Tokens Community Group (2025.10)

Vale AST Automated Verbal Linting Engine

How is verbal brand governance enforced—through static PDF style manuals, or via automated AST linting within continuous integration pipelines?



SCHEMATIC

Manifest at key 1 of 3

BRA-39

Vale AST Automated Verbal Linting Engine

ARTIFACT

A `.vale.ini` configuration paired with custom YAML style rules enforcing tone boundaries, banned terminology, and reading ease during build time.

ANTI-PATTERN

Writing broad, complex regex patterns that throw frequent false positives, leading engineering and writing teams to disable the linter.

Declarative Brand Identity Schema (`brand.yaml`)

Can an automated agent or human contributor review our strategic positioning, voice rules, and visual assets from a single structured repository manifest?



SCHEMATIC

Manifest at key 1 of 3

BRA-40

Declarative Brand Identity Schema (`brand.yaml`)

ARTIFACT

A validated, schema-compliant `brand.yaml` manifest that serves as the root source of truth for the entire brand identity system.

ANTI-PATTERN

Fragmenting brand strategy across disconnected Google Docs, Notion pages, and Slack threads, allowing context to drift over time.

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gramatr/brand-spec, brandspec, cofoundy/brand-skills

Distinctive Asset Decay & Dilution Audit

Which distinctive brand cues have eroded over the past three years due to inconsistent execution, category mimicry, or neglected usage?



SCHEMATIC

Ledger at part 3 of 3

BRA-41

Distinctive Asset Decay & Dilution Audit

ARTIFACT

A Triennial Asset Erosion Audit Log tracking original vs. current association strength, competitor mimicry, and corrective actions (Re-anchor, Restrict, or Retire).

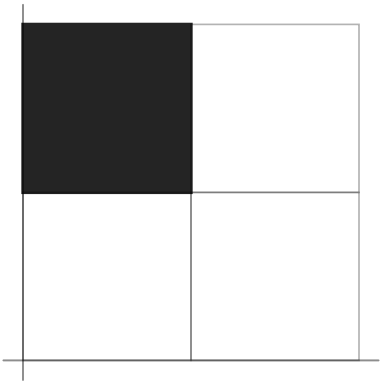
ANTI-PATTERN

Changing core visual marks to match short-term aesthetic trends, damaging established customer recognition pathways.

Ehrenberg-Bass Institute

Multi-Sensory Cognitive Anchor Matrix

Does the brand rely exclusively on visual marks, or does it activate sonic, haptic, and spatial cues across its touchpoints?



SCHEMATIC

Matrix at cell 1 of 4

BRA-42

Multi-Sensory Cognitive Anchor Matrix

ARTIFACT

Visual assets: marks, palettes, typography.
Sonic assets: chimes, UI interaction sounds.
Haptic assets: physical substrates, vibration feedback.
Spatial assets: interface hierarchy, environmental layouts.

ANTI-PATTERN

Introducing shrill or intrusive notification sounds that annoy users, driving them to mute or disable interface audio.

Charles Spence & Martin Lindstrom (2005)